

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
What are the 3 dynasties and their dates? Song Yuan Ming What is the AP CCOT theme for this chapter? What is the Mandate of Heaven? AP EXAM TIP CCOT essays are the #1 prompt type for this chapter. Know what CHANGED under Yuan and what stayed CONTINUOUS across all three dynasties. Key concept: Commercial Revolution How did each dynasty justify its authority?	SONG DYNASTY (960–1279) World's most commercially advanced civilization by 1200. Refined civil service exam system, Neo-Confucianism as state ideology. Produced gunpowder, movable type, compass, and paper money. Fell to Jurchen Jin (north, 1127) then Mongols (1279). YUAN DYNASTY (1271–1368) Mongol rule under Kublai Khan — first foreign dynasty to rule ALL of China. Imposed 4-tier ethnic hierarchy (Mongols > Central Asians > N. Chinese > S. Chinese). Suspended civil service exams. Integrated China into the Pax Mongolica trade network. Fell due to Black Death + floods + peasant rebellions. MING DYNASTY (1368–1644) Founded by peasant rebel Zhu Yuanzhang (Hongwu Emperor). Expelled Mongols, restored civil service exams, reasserted Confucian governance. Sponsored Zheng He's voyages (1405–1433), then abruptly ended them. Expanded the Great Wall. Established the tribute system as primary foreign policy tool. THE CENTRAL CCOT NARRATIVE › CONTINUITY across all 3: Civil service examination, Confucian bureaucracy, centralized imperial authority, Chinese written language › CHANGE under Yuan: Ethnic hierarchy, bypassing of Chinese officials, integration into Mongol trade network › CHANGE under Ming: End of maritime expansion (1433), haijin (maritime ban), anti-merchant conservatism MANDATE OF HEAVEN (tianming) Chinese concept: rulers derive authority from divine approval. Lose moral legitimacy = lose the right to rule = justified rebellion. Used to explain EVERY dynasty change — including Zhu Yuanzhang's peasant rebellion.
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Ch. 1 spans 3 dynasties: Song (960–1279) → Yuan (1271–1368) → Ming (1368–1644). The AP core narrative: **Confucian bureaucracy = continuity** across all three; **Mongol conquest = disruption**; Ming = restoration with new conservatism. Always ask: what changed, what stayed the same, and why?

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

What caused the Song 'commercial revolution'?

Champa Rice

→ What chain reaction did it cause?

Neo-Confucianism

Who developed it? What did it reinforce?

Civil Service Exam

Who benefited? What class did it create?

AP EXAM TIP

Song innovations spread globally via Silk Roads. Always explain the **MECHANISM** of spread — not just that they spread.

Social hierarchy (lowest to highest)?

COMMON MISTAKE

Song was **NOT** weak — it was economically dominant. It fell to military pressure from nomads, not economic failure.

THE COMMERCIAL REVOLUTION: Cause-and-Effect Chain

- › **Champa rice** (imported from Vietnam) → drought-resistant, fast-ripening → doubled crop yields
- › Population boom (~50M to ~100M by 1200) → surplus urban labor → city growth
- › Urbanization → commercial specialization → merchant class growth
- › Long-distance trade → need for portable currency → **paper money** (jiaozi) → early credit systems
- › Indian Ocean trade via advanced **junks** (watertight bulkheads, multiple masts)

NEO-CONFUCIANISM (codified by Zhu Xi, Song era)

Blended classical Confucianism with Buddhist and Daoist ideas. Emphasized moral self-cultivation, filial piety, and social hierarchy. Became the dominant state ideology — and spread to Korea, Japan, and Vietnam (**Sinification**). Reinforced patriarchal control over women.

CIVIL SERVICE EXAMINATION SYSTEM

Tested mastery of Confucian classics. Theoretically open to all men — promoted the idea of meritocracy. Created the **scholar-gentry** class (educated elite who held administrative posts). In practice, preparation time and resources favored wealthy families. This class later **blocked** Ming maritime expansion.

SOCIAL HIERARCHY (Confucian ranking):

- › 1st: Scholar-Gentry | 2nd: Peasants | 3rd: Artisans | 4th: Merchants

Paradox: Merchants generated enormous commercial wealth but were officially ranked **LOWEST** because Confucian values prized intellectual/moral achievement over material gain.

FOOT BINDING — Social Structures Exam Evidence

Practice of binding young girls' feet, spreading across social classes during Song era. AP significance: reflects **intensification of patriarchal control**. Use as evidence in Social Structures theme essays about gender hierarchy.

AP TIP: Song = 'commercial revolution' + Neo-Confucian social order + world-leading technology. Know it as a **HIGH** point of Chinese civilization before Mongol conquest.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Song Dynasty = world's most advanced economy by 1200. The commercial revolution began with **Champa rice** → **population growth** → **urbanization** → **paper money**. Neo-Confucianism unified culture across dynasties. Key social paradox: merchants ranked lowest despite driving the economy. Song innovations (gunpowder, compass, printing) spread globally via Silk Roads.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Who was Kublai Khan?

Pax Mongolica

What was it? Why does it matter for global history?

Yuan ethnic hierarchy:

Name all 4 tiers in order.

What did the Mongols KEEP from Chinese civilization?

How and why did the Yuan fall?

AP EXAM TIP

Yuan = **SIGNIFICANT CHANGE** in governance structure, **BUT** cultural continuity survived. This nuance = complexity points on DBQ.

Failed invasions:

Where? Why did they fail?

Who was Marco Polo? Why include him in essays?

KUBLAI KHAN (r. 1260–1294)

Grandson of Genghis Khan. Founded Yuan Dynasty 1271. Completed conquest of Southern Song 1279. Great Khan of the Mongol Empire. Made his capital at **Khanbaliq** (modern Beijing). Attempted failed invasions of Japan (1274, 1281) and Java.

THE PAX MONGOLICA ('Mongol Peace')

Mongol control across Eurasia (from China to Persia to Russia) made the Silk Roads safe and heavily trafficked. Enabled: Marco Polo's travels (c. 1271–1292), Ibn Battuta's journeys, and massive east-west trade. **Downside:** also enabled the westward spread of the **Black Death** along these same routes.

YUAN ETHNIC HIERARCHY (4 tiers)

- › **1st: Mongols** — top governmental positions
 - › **2nd: Semu** (Central Asians, Persians, Arabs) — trusted administrators
 - › **3rd: Hanren** (Northern Chinese, former Jin subjects)
 - › **4th: Nanren** (Southern Chinese, former Song subjects) — most restricted
- Result: Civil service exams **suspended**. Chinese officials replaced by Mongols/foreigners. Deep ethnic resentment → fueled Ming rebellion.

WHAT THE YUAN KEPT (Cultural Continuity)

- › Chinese administrative machinery at local level
- › Chinese written language and literary traditions
- › Buddhism and Neo-Confucianism (survived Mongol rule)
- › Welcomed foreign merchants and travelers (Marco Polo, Muslim traders)

YUAN COLLAPSE — Multi-Causal (1340s–1368)

- › **Black Death** (1330s–1350s): arrived via Mongol trade routes, killed millions
- › **Environmental disaster:** Yellow River floods, famines → peasant suffering
- › **Ethnic resentment** → peasant rebellions across China
- › **Mandate of Heaven** withdrawn → Zhu Yuanzhang's Red Turban rebellion → Ming 1368

AP TIP: Yuan = **CHANGE** (ethnic hierarchy, governance) + **CONTINUITY** (Confucian culture survived). The Mongol period's most lasting impact was *indirect*: resentment it generated created the deliberately conservative Ming Dynasty.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Yuan Dynasty (1271–1368): Mongols changed **who ruled and how** (ethnic hierarchy, bypassed Chinese officials) but Confucian culture proved resilient. The Pax Mongolica boosted Silk Road trade but also spread the Black Death. Multi-causal collapse: plague + floods + resentment. Key for AP: argue Yuan = significant change in governance, significant cultural continuity.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Zhu Yuanzhang / Hongwu Emperor*Background? Key policies?***Yongle Emperor***What 3 major things did he do?***Zheng He's Voyages***Dates? Where? Purpose? Fleet size?**WHY did the voyages end?**(Give 3 reasons)***AP EXAM TIP**

1433 = top AP turning point. Know: WHY voyages ended + contrast with European exploration beginning just decades later.

Tribute System*How did it work? Who used it?***Great Wall***Why did the Ming expand it?***Haijin policy:***What was it?***HONGWU EMPEROR — Zhu Yuanzhang (r. 1368–1398)**

Peasant-born rebel leader who overthrew the Yuan. Set the tone for Ming conservatism: **restored civil service exams**, abolished the position of prime minister (concentrated all power in the emperor), implemented agrarian reforms to rebuild war-devastated China. Deep distrust of merchants and foreign influence.

YONGLE EMPEROR (r. 1402–1424)

- › Moved the capital from Nanjing to **Beijing** (reorienting Ming toward northern defense)
- › Commissioned the **Forbidden City** (completed 1421) — symbol of Ming grandeur
- › Sponsored all seven of **Zheng He's voyages** and the Yongle Encyclopedia

ZHENG HE'S VOYAGES (1405–1433) — 7 expeditions

- › **Fleet:** 300+ ships; 'treasure ships' up to 400 ft long (dwarfed European vessels)
- › **Destinations:** SE Asia, India, Arabia, Persian Gulf, East Africa (Swahili Coast)
- › **Purpose:** *Tributary diplomacy* — extend Ming prestige, collect exotic gifts, bring rulers into the tribute system. NOT colonization. NOT private commerce.
- › **Admiral:** Zheng He — a Muslim Chinese eunuch official

WHY THE VOYAGES ENDED — Know All Reasons

- › 1. **Confucian scholar-gentry opposition:** viewed maritime trade as wasteful, beneath imperial dignity, and merchants as low-status
- › 2. **Death of Yongle Emperor (1424)** — successors had no interest in maritime ventures
- › 3. **Death of Zheng He (1433)** — lost the champion of the program
- › 4. **Fiscal cost** — voyages were enormously expensive state projects
- › 5. **Haijin policy** — Ming maritime ban restricted private and state sea trade

Historical significance: Just 60 years later (1492–1498), Columbus and da Gama begin European exploration. Ming's inward turn = one of history's great 'what ifs.'

TRIBUTE SYSTEM

Neighboring states (Korea, Japan, Vietnam, SE Asian kingdoms) sent **tribute missions** bearing gifts → acknowledged Chinese superiority → received trading rights, protection, and legitimacy. Hierarchical, NOT equal. Allowed Ming to project power without military conquest.

AP TIP: Contrast Zheng He's state-sponsored, tributary voyages with European merchant-driven, profit-seeking exploration. This comparison appears on virtually every AP exam covering this period.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Ming = Confucian restoration after Mongol rule. Two key legacies: (1) Zheng He's voyages (1405–1433) = greatest naval achievement of the era, ended by Confucian conservatism not lack of capability; (2) the tribute system organized all East Asian diplomatic relations. **1433 is the pivotal turning point** — China turns inward just as Europe turns outward.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

List the 5 key Chinese technologies in this chapter.

Gunpowder

How did it spread? What did it enable globally?

Movable Type

When? Why globally important?

Magnetic Compass

How did it reach Europe?

Paper Money (jiaozi)**Champa Rice**

Source? Effect on China?

AP EXAM TIP

Always state the **MECHANISM** of spread (Silk Roads → Islamic world → Europe) not just 'China invented it and it spread.'

How do these technologies connect to Units 3 and 4?

Junks

What made them superior?

GUNPOWDER

- › Invented in China (Tang/Song era). Initially: fireworks and signal rockets
- › Military applications: fire arrows, bombs, early guns/cannon (by 13th c.)
- › **Spread:** Silk Roads → Islamic world (Mongol era) → Europe (14th–15th c.)
- › **Global impact:** Transformed warfare; enabled the *gunpowder empires* (Ottomans, Mughals, Safavids) in Unit 3; European firearms later gave colonizers advantages over indigenous peoples in Units 4–6

MOVABLE TYPE PRINTING (bi sheng, Song era)

- › Individual reusable characters — preceded Gutenberg's press by ~400 years
- › Accelerated spread of: literacy, Buddhism, Neo-Confucianism, administrative documents
- › **Long-term:** Gutenberg's adaptation (c. 1440) → Protestant Reformation → Scientific Revolution (Units 3–4)

MAGNETIC COMPASS

- › Chinese invention, refined in Song era for maritime navigation
- › Spread via Indian Ocean trade → Arab merchants → European navigators
- › Made Zheng He's voyages possible; later enabled Portuguese/Spanish exploration

PAPER MONEY — jiaozi (Song)

- › First government-issued paper currency in world history
- › Reflects sophistication of Chinese commercial economy
- › Yuan Dynasty also issued paper currency (Marco Polo reported this, astonishing Europeans)
- › Prefigures modern banking and fiat currency systems

CHAMPA RICE (agricultural technology transfer)

- › Fast-ripening, drought-resistant rice variety imported from Vietnam (Champa Kingdom)
- › Allowed two crops per year in S. China; dramatically increased yields
- › → Population boom (50M → 100M) → urbanization → commercial revolution (see Page 2)

JUNKS — Chinese seafaring technology

- › Multi-masted sailing ships with **watertight compartmentalized hulls**
- › Far larger and more seaworthy than contemporary Arab dhows or European vessels
- › Enabled Indian Ocean trade and Zheng He's treasure ship voyages

MECHANISM OF TECHNOLOGY SPREAD

China → Silk Roads / Indian Ocean trade → **Islamic world** (key intermediary) → Europe. Islamic scholars and merchants translated, adapted, and transmitted Chinese knowledge westward. This chain appears repeatedly across AP World History.

AP TIP: On any essay about technology and exchange, state: (1) what was invented, (2) how it spread (mechanism), (3) who adapted it, (4) what long-term global consequence resulted.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Five key Chinese innovations: **gunpowder** (transformed global warfare), **movable type** (accelerated literacy and later the Reformation), **compass** (enabled ocean navigation), **paper money** (sophisticated commercial economy), **Champa rice** (population boom). All spread via Silk Roads through Islamic intermediaries. Always name the spread mechanism in AP essays.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS

NOTES

Sinification

Define it. Which 3 countries experienced it?

How did Korea's Goryeo Dynasty reflect Sinification?

Japan's shogunate:

Emperor vs. Shogun — what's the difference?

COMMON MISTAKE

The Emperor had cultural/religious authority. The Shogun held real military/political power. Do NOT confuse them.

Kamikaze

What were they? Why historically significant?

AP EXAM TIP

Japan = the counter-example to Sinification. Selectively adopted Chinese culture but maintained distinct political structure and RESISTED Mongol conquest.

What does foot binding reveal about Song society?

How does Vietnam fit into Sinification?

SINIFICATION — Cultural Influence Without Conquest

The process by which Korea, Japan, and Vietnam voluntarily adopted Chinese cultural practices: written language (Chinese characters), Buddhism, Confucian philosophy, administrative systems, and civil service exams. Shows that cultural power ≠ military conquest. Reflects China's central role in East Asian civilization.

KOREA — Goryeo Dynasty (918–1392)

- › Adopted Chinese-style **civil service examinations** and Neo-Confucianism as state ideology
- › Created the **Tripitaka Koreana** (1251) — 80,000 woodblock-printed Buddhist texts; example of Sinification blending with Korean Buddhist tradition
- › Developed distinctive **celadon pottery** — shows how Korea adapted, not just copied, Chinese culture
- › Became a **vassal state of the Yuan Dynasty** — demonstrates Mongol reach into East Asia

JAPAN — Kamakura Shogunate (1185–1333)

- › **Emperor** = ceremonial/religious figurehead (cultural authority only)
- › **Shogun** = real political and military ruler (bakufu government)
- › **Samurai** = warrior elite class (compare to European knights for AP essays)
- › Adopted: Chinese writing, Buddhism, Confucian values — *selectively*
- › **Repelled Mongol invasions (1274 & 1281):** Typhoons (*kamikaze* = 'divine winds') destroyed Mongol fleets both times. Japanese samurai resistance also effective. Demonstrates LIMITS of Mongol expansion.

VIETNAM — Selective Sinification

Adopted Chinese writing system and Buddhism but maintained Vietnamese language, local culture, and political independence. Example of cultural borrowing without full assimilation.

GENDER & SOCIAL STRUCTURES — Foot Binding

- › Practice of tightly binding young girls' feet, originating in elite Song circles and spreading across social classes over time
- › **AP significance:** Evidence of intensifying patriarchal control under Neo-Confucianism. Use in Social Structures theme essays on gender hierarchy.
- › Persisted until the 20th century — AP CCOT example of patriarchal continuity across periods

YUAN'S ADDED ETHNIC LAYER

The Yuan imposed a **4-tier ethnic hierarchy** on top of the existing Confucian social structure, creating an additional dimension of inequality. Chinese of all classes were subordinated to Mongols/semu. This ethnic stratification generated the resentment that brought the Yuan down.

SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:

Sinification = cultural power without conquest; Korea and Vietnam adopted Chinese systems most fully. **Japan** is the counterexample: selective adoption + distinct shogunate structure + successful resistance to Mongols. **Foot binding** = AP evidence for gender hierarchy under Neo-Confucianism. Social paradox: merchants ranked lowest despite driving the commercial revolution.

CUES & AP QUESTIONS	NOTES
CCOT Framework: <i>What are 3 continuities and 3 changes for Ch. 1?</i> <i>Top 4 essay prompts for this chapter:</i> Key comparisons: <i>Name 4 AP-ready comparisons from Ch. 1.</i> AP EXAM TIP Every Ch. 1 essay should connect Chinese innovations to their GLOBAL consequences. Don't stop at 'it spread' — say how and what changed. COMMON MISTAKES List 4 errors students make on Ch. 1 essays. <i>How do you earn complexity points on a Ch. 1 DBQ?</i> <i>Key terms to define in essays:</i>	CCOT FRAMEWORK FOR CHAPTER 1 › CONTINUITIES: Civil service exams (restored after Yuan), Confucian bureaucracy, imperial centralization, Chinese language & written culture, Neo-Confucianism as ideology › CHANGES: Yuan ethnic hierarchy & suspension of exams Ming's end of maritime expansion (1433) Ming haijin maritime restrictions Black Death depopulation › CONTEXT: All occur within the broader Mongol disruption of Eurasia (1200–1350) TOP AP ESSAY PROMPTS — Know These Cold › 1. DBQ: 'Evaluate the extent to which Mongol rule changed Chinese society and governance.' → Answer: significant governance change (ethnic hierarchy) + significant cultural continuity (Confucianism survived); complexity = Yuan deepened Silk Road commerce › 2. LEQ: 'Analyze continuity and change in East Asian governance from 1200–1450.' → Use CCOT framework; Song → Yuan → Ming arc › 3. SAQ: 'Explain ONE cause and ONE effect of the end of Zheng He's voyages.' → Confucian opposition; effect = reduced Chinese Indian Ocean presence, space for others › 4. LEQ: 'Compare the Ming tribute system to another form of interregional interaction.' → Use Islamic trade networks OR European feudal relationships KEY AP-READY COMPARISONS › Zheng He vs. Portuguese exploration: State/tributary vs. merchant/commercial; ended by conservatism vs. continued; diplomatic vs. profit-driven › Chinese civil service vs. Islamic madrasa education: Both create educated administrative classes; different religious/philosophical foundations › Japan's shogunate vs. European feudalism: Both decentralized warrior nobility; figurehead monarchs; Japan resisted outside conquest › Song commercial revolution vs. Islamic commercial networks: Both reflect sophisticated market economies; different organizational structures COMMON MISTAKES TO AVOID › ✗ 'China gave up exploration due to lack of technology' — they had superior ships. It was a <i>political/ideological</i> choice. › ✗ Confusing Song (Chinese), Yuan (Mongol), Ming (Chinese) dates and rulers › ✗ 'The Mongols destroyed Confucianism' — it survived the Yuan period; continuity is the key point › ✗ 'Innovations spread' — without naming the mechanism (Silk Roads + Islamic intermediaries) KEY TERMS TO DEFINE IN ESSAYS Tribute system Sinification Neo-Confucianism Pax Mongolica Mandate of Heaven Scholar-gentry Haijin policy Champa rice Kamikaze Khanate
SUMMARY — Write the main idea of this page in your own words:	

Chapter 1 AP mastery = three things: (1) **CCOT:** Confucian continuity across dynasties, Mongol disruption, Ming conservatism; (2) **Turning point:** 1433 — China turns inward as Europe turns outward; (3) **Global connections:** Chinese innovations → Silk Roads → Islamic world → Europe. Master the Zheng He comparison and you can answer virtually any Ch. 1 LEQ or SAQ.